

PART IV & PART V

BARH — COMPASSION, RESPONSIBILITY & DIGNITY



A JOURNEY OF RESCUE • FAMILY • RESPONSIBILITY • DIGNITY

PART IV — BARH AND THE TWO PUPPIES

A New Chapter in Bihar

After this period, his work eventually brought him to Barh, Bihar. He tried spot treatment for injured animals, but several cases still ended in death: calves, dogs, and a goat. Experience had taught him that good intentions did not guarantee survival.

TWO PUPPIES ENTER HIS LIFE

Then two puppies entered his life. Their mother had died after being hit by a truck on the highway. The puppies were only about three or four months old and had severe maggot-infested wounds.

This time he decided to try something different: rather than immediately leaving them elsewhere, he would try to care for them himself while seeking treatment.

THE FIGHT TO KEEP THEM ALIVE

Their recovery required repeated journeys from Barh to the Government Veterinary Hospital in Patna, sometimes two or three times a month, travelling by train and auto while also dealing with public hostility and abuse. During that period, his attention was fixed on one goal: keep them alive and help them recover.

At the hospital, Dr. Mithilesh Kumar, described by the author as the HOD, and his team helped significantly. He says the puppies received treatment without doctor fees or operation fees. Other cases of recurring pus-filled lumps and illness were also part of his experience. One adult dog with a broken leg was returned to its locality; an adult dog with cancer was another difficult case. The two puppies, however, gradually became impossible for him to treat as temporary strangers.

In Barh, he also remembers support from Mohit Kumar at the Government Veterinary Hospital, Mr. Rahul Raj of Shanti Pet Care, Paramanand Yadav of Ohh My Dog, Tara Medicine Shop, Jaggannath Pharma, Dr. Varun Sharma, and many volunteers and local people who helped in different ways.

FROM RESCUE TO FAMILY

At first, he had believed that after recovery the puppies could return to the place from which they had been picked up. That plan changed. He contacted a nearby NGO or shelter by message and phone, hoping they might take the puppies. For about three months, the matter was delayed. During that time the puppies came closer and closer to his heart.

He began asking himself whether another shelter could truly care for them more than he had learned to love and care for them. When the answer finally came as 'No', after the long period of waiting, he smiled and prayed: if this responsibility had been given to him, then may he also be given the strength to face the catastrophes that come with it.

What began as temporary care had become family. His original 'foolishness', as he calls it, was believing that love could always be separated from responsibility once recovery was complete. Instead, responsibility slowly became attachment, and attachment became love.

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PART V — THE LAST ACT OF COMPASSION

Dignity After Death

The lesson of the female dog and the many animals encountered later shaped another part of his life: he found it difficult to leave the bodies of animals killed on the road.

FINAL CARE FOR THE ANIMALS

In Barh, when dogs, calves, goats, or other animals died in road accidents around NH31, he would sometimes carry the bodies himself. If the weight was manageable, he carried the animal on his back or transported it by bicycle toward a place for burial. These journeys could happen at eleven at night, midnight, or two in the morning.

He carried flowers, incense sticks, camphor, naphthalene balls, a matchbox, salt, vermilion, and turmeric. Depending on the circumstances and size of the body, he arranged a respectful burial or other final rites with reverence. He sometimes recited the mantra: 'Aghorebhyo tatha Ghorebhyo Ghora Ghoratarebhyah, Sarvebhyah Sarva Sarvebhyo Namaste Astu Rudra Rupebhyah.'

COMPASSION BEYOND FEAR

He admits that he sometimes felt fear when entering a cremation-ground area at night. Yet responsibility remained stronger than fear. According to his own count, he had given such final care to 15 dogs, 2 goats, and 2 calves.

For him, compassion did not end when a heartbeat stopped. Respect for life also meant refusing to treat a dead body as meaningless waste. Dignity, he believed, should not disappear simply because a living being can no longer speak or move.

COMPASSION DOES NOT END WITH A HEARTBEAT

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THE JOURNEY CONTINUES

COMPASSION • RESPONSIBILITY • TRUST



EVERY LIFE DESERVES CARE AND DIGNITY